

SECTION 24: REFRIGERANT HANDLING SYSTEM SOP

Purpose: Establish standardized practices for safely handling, transferring, storing, and recovering refrigerants used in HVACR systems. This ensures compliance with EPA Section 608, reduces environmental harm, and protects personnel.

Applies To:

Split systems, rooftop units, chillers, and heat pumps
Refrigerants including R-22, R-410A, R-134a, CO₂, and new low-GWP blends
Recovery equipment, tanks, gauges, and charging tools

Daily Refrigerant Checks:

Monitor equipment for refrigerant leaks or pressure abnormalities.
Confirm proper valve caps and seals are in place on service ports.
Inspect condition of gauges, hoses, and vacuum pump oil levels.
Review ambient/system pressure consistency via gauges or sensors.

Weekly Refrigerant Handling Tasks:

Leak check using electronic or bubble solution around fittings.
Document refrigerant added or recovered (type, weight, and reason).
Verify labeling of recovery cylinders and service tools.
Ensure storage area is ventilated and tanks are upright and secured.
Cross-check recovery logs with EPA guidelines.